



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Policy Standard Operating Procedure on the Management of Sick Leave

Title: Policy and Standard Operating Procedure on the Management Sick Leave	Number JCF/FW/PL/Adm/0014/2021
Effective Date: January 10, 2025	Pages: 9
Review Date: January 08, 2025	Distribution: Force Wide
Revision # 3	Process Owners: Deputy Commissioner of Police Administration and Support Services Portfolio
Rescinds: Force Orders # 3725, 3715	
Authors: PRDB	Owner: JCF
First Published: F.O. # 1839 1982-2-9	Review: Biennially

1.0 Introduction

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) is cognizant that members may become ill, this can adversely impacting operational plan at any level. Therefore, management in such instances must take remedial action to optimize resources to continue satisfying the needs of the people we serve. To this end proper accountability, the function that will guide the success of the organization must be upheld; accountability of time absent from work due to illness. To ensure seamlessness in operation, the JCF has outlined its responsibilities and that of members in cases where a member report sick.

This Sick Leave Policy provides a standardized approach to reporting whenever a member who is required for duty becomes ill, the submission of sick leave and it stipulate the obligations of the organization. It seeks to reinforce the JCF's commitment to its Strategic Priorities *numbers 4 and 5, Enhancing Staff Welfare and Improving Accountability and Professional Standards* respectively.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- i. Allow for consistency in how members who are ill report;
- ii. Ensure management of records; and
- iii. Accountability of members and for better efficiency.

3.0 Scope

This policy and standard operating procedures apply to all sworn members of the JCF. It outlines the responsibilities of members in instances where they become ill and the obligation of the organization in ensuring the speedy recovery of members.

4.0 Policy Statement

It is the policy of the JCF that:

- 4.1 The welfare of sick members are treated with urgency;
- 4.2 Confidentiality and tactfulness are employed in the handling of member's medical information;
- 4.3 members are not discriminated against in any manner for utilizing sick leave;
- 4.4 members are granted twenty eight days per year upon the presentation of a medical certificate.
sick members be visited by a sub-officer

5.0 Standard Operating Procedures

5.1 Sick Leave Locally

Where a member who was detailed for duty fell ill, he/she shall:

- 5.1.1 immediately contact the Station/Division/Branch and report sick;
- 5.1.2 forthwith attend a Medical Officer who may recommend leave on a medical certificate for such period as he thinks fit, for the attention of the Commissioner of Police;
- 5.1.3 submit a sick leave along with the medical certificate **PERSONALLY** to the Sub-Officer in charge of the Station to which he is attached within 48 consecutive hours and where that is not possible;
 - 5.1.3.1 submit sick leave personally to the Sub-Officer on duty at the station for the area in which he is staying within 48 consecutive hours of reporting sick; or
 - 5.1.3.2 send sick leave and medical certificate by bearer to the Sub-Officer in charge where the member is prevented by circumstances such as the gravity of his illness;
- 5.1.4 state the address at which he will be staying during the period when submitting the sick leave;
- 5.1.5 make himself available for visitation.

5.2 Medical Certificate:

The Sub officer shall upon receipt of the medical certificate:

- 5.2.1 cause an entry to be made in the Station Diary about the facts including the name and address of the person handing in the documents;
- 5.2.2 update the Medical Journal;

5.3 Visitation of Sick Member

Members who report sick must be properly accounted for and their whereabouts established and as such upon receipt of the medical certificate the Sub officer shall:

- 5.3.1 promptly visit the sick member or cause him to be visited; and
- 5.3.2 report on his condition to his Divisional Officer who will in turn inform the member's Divisional Officer (if he is not the member's Divisional Officer)
 - 5.3.2.1 where the member is not found a message must be left with some responsible person that he, the sick member, is to report to the Sub-Officer within 24 hours;
 - 5.3.2.2 the circumstances met along with the name and address of the person(s) with whom the message was left is to be recorded in the Station Diary;
 - 5.3.2.3 if the member fails to so report, the Sub-Officer shall immediately visit him again;

- 5.3.2.4 where he is still not found another entry must be made in the Station Diary;
- 5.3.2.5 a written report shall be sent by dispatch to the Divisional Officer who will communicate with the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Administration for the appropriate action to be taken;
- 5.3.2.6 the Sub-Officer shall institute investigations to ascertain the whereabouts of the sick member;
- 5.3.2.7 If at the expiration of the period of sick leave granted the member is still sick, the procedure listed from 5.3.2.1 above shall be repeated until the member resumes duty or is passed unfit for further service;
- 5.3.3 Members have a duty to report all cases of gainful employment of their colleagues whilst they are on sick leave from the Force.
- 5.4 **Protracted Sick Leave**
The following shall apply in cases where a member experienced illness that necessitates protracted sick leave:
 - 5.4.1 the member shall be visited by his sub-officer; or
 - 5.4.2 the sub-officer in charge of the station for the area in which he is staying and his condition reported on at least twice per month;
 - 5.4.3 each visit must be entered in the Station Diary;
 - 5.4.4 where a member is extremely ill or became ill as a result of the job he shall be visited by the Divisional Officer;
 - 5.4.5 ensure that every possible assistance is given to him for him to obtain proper medical care.
 - 5.4.6 the Community Safety and Security Branch shall visit the member and render him whatever assistance possible.
- 5.5 **Medical Board**
The following procedures are to be adopted where a member's illness requires him/her is to be medical Board:
 - 5.5.1 The member will be required by his Commanding Officer to have the doctor treating him/her complete the prescribed Medical Certificate form (Appendix A) in triplicate where:
 - 5.5.1.1 he/she is on continuous sick leave for over ninety days due to injury or disease not resulting from duty; or
 - 5.5.1.2 he/she is on continuous sick leave for over 180 days due to injury or disease in the execution of duty;
 - 5.5.1.3 where Officers encounter difficulties in obtaining Medical Certificates from Medical Officers, in order to request a Medical Board at the time prescribed by the Rule, the matter should be promptly reported to Police Headquarters for action at this level;

- 5.5.2 all three copies of the form shall be sent to ACP Administration along with a report on the circumstances of the member's illness;
- 5.5.3 ACP Administration shall request the Chief Medical Officer, Ministry of Health to convene a Medical Board,
- 5.5.4 The Chief Medical Officer, upon receiving this request, will inform the General Hospital nearest to the member's division;
- 5.5.5 The hospital would then arrange a date for the Medical Board and inform Police Headquarters of this date.
- 5.5.6 The member's division shall be informed by Police Headquarters to have the member warned at the earliest possible time and assisted where necessary to attend the Medical Board.
- 5.5.7 The hospital would then arrange a date for the Medical Board and inform Police Headquarters of this date.
- 5.5.8 The member's division will then be informed by Police Headquarters to have the member warned and assisted where necessary to attend the Medical Board.
- 5.5.9 At the completion of the board, the Medical Board report with the findings and recommendations will be sent to the Chief Medical Officer, Ministry of Health who will forward same to Police Headquarters.
- 5.5.10 In the instance where a member is found unfit for further service, the Medical Board Report is enclosed in the member's file and the member informed through his/her Commanding Officer.
- 5.5.11 Thereafter, recommendation shall be made by the Commissioner of Police to the Police Service Commission for the member to be discharged from the Force as physically unfit for further service.
- 5.5.12 In instances where other recommendations are made by the Medical Board, these will be communicated to the member's Commanding Officer for the requisite action to be taken.
- 5.5.13 where the member satisfies the conditions for the grant of a pension, that is, has completed over ten (10) years service, he/she will be granted a pension.
- 5.5.14 where the member has less than ten (10) years service, a gratuity will be paid.

5.6 **Sick Leave Abroad**

Members becoming ill whilst on leave abroad and necessitating sick leave shall:

- 5.6.1 immediately see a certified medical practitioner;
- 5.6.2 communicate personally or through a contact person via telephone or fax with the Office of the Assistant Commissioner of Police Administration and his/her Divisional Officer within three (3) days of the date the member becomes ill;
- 5.6.3 send, or cause to be sent, a medical certificate to his/her Divisional Officer within five (5) working days;
- 5.6.4 ensure that the medical certificate states the nature of his/her illness, fitness to travel and the number of days recommended;

5.6.5 Obligation of the Divisional Officer

The Divisional Officer must:

- 5.6.5.1 maintain contact with the member or his/her contact person; and
- 5.6.5.2 update the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Administration on the member's progress until he/she returns to the island;

5.6.6 Serious illness or hospitalized:

- 5.6.6.1 the Consul General/High Commission for the particular country must be communicated with within seven (7) days by the member, a relative, caregiver and/or any other available means;
- 5.6.6.2 the Consul General will communicate with the Ministry of Foreign Affairs to inform the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Administration, who will monitor the member's progress;
- 5.6.6.3 the Consul General will monitor the member's condition and intervene where appropriate; and
- 5.6.6.4 the member is responsible to give fortnightly reports on his/her condition to his/her Divisional Commander and must give a time frame within which he/she will return to the island.

5.6.7 Returning of Sick Member

Upon returning to the island, if the member is unfit to resume duties he/she will:

- 5.6.7.1 immediately make contact with his/her Divisional Commander and provide a telephone number and address at which he/she will be recuperating;
- 5.6.7.2 make note of the name of the person he/she reported to and the time; and
- 5.6.7.3 make himself/herself available to be visited.

5.6.8 Utilization of Vacation and Department Leave for Sick Purposes

Members who have exhausted their 28 days sick leave and afterwards become ill, ACP admin shall:

- 5.6.8.1 deduct from their unused departmental leave all sick leave;
- 5.6.8.2 where unused departmental leave is insufficient then half of the vacation leave earned prior to the member becoming sick shall be used to deducted the sick days.

5.6.9 Monthly Returns

Commanding Officer shall:

- 5.6.9.1 Submit monthly returns or nil returns by the 5th of each succeeding month to ACP Administration Branch to facilitate update of personnel records; and
- 5.6.9.2 Administrative action relative to the adjustment of salaries etc

8.2.6 The address of the Jamaica Consul General in the United States of America (USA) is:

Jamaica Consul General
767 Third Avenue
2nd Floor
New York 10017
USA
Tel. No. 212 935 9000

for Canada:

High Commission of Jamaica
151 Slater Street
Suite 1000 Ottawa
Ontario K1P 5H3
Tel. No. 613 233 9311

for England:

High Commission of Jamaica
1 – 2 Prince Consort Road
London SW7 2BZ
Tel. No. 207 823 9911

For other countries, the onus is on the member to obtain the address and other relevant information before he/she departs the island.

6.0 Roles and Function

6.1 Divisional Officer

The Divisional Officer shall:

- i. visit members on protracted sick leave and ensure matters of their welfare are dealt with promptly;
- ii. ensure monthly report and sent to ACP Area;

6.2 Sub Officer i/c Stations

The sub officer i/c of station shall:

- i. visit members on sick leave twice per month, inform the Divisional Officer via report on the state of members on protracted sick leave
- ii. record all relevant entries relative to the member who is ill
- iii. Account for sick days by updating records;
- iv. Expedite all processes in relation to members welfare

JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

MONTHLY SICK LEAVE RETURNS

MONTH:

YEAR:

DIVISION/BRANCH:

[illegible]

I HEREBY CERTIFY that on the.....day of..... 20.....

I personally examined..... at present employed in the Public
Service of the Colony as.....and find that the said.....

is for reasons set forth in the settlement furnished below incapacitated for the further discharge of
his/her public duties.

STATEMENT

- 1. Principal symptoms of disease or infirmity
- 2. Duration
- 3. Supposed cause
- 4. Diagnosis
- 5. Prognosis
- (a) Is the infirmity or disease likely to be permanent?
- (b) Is the person named incapable of obtaining his
 livelihood in any other way:
- (c) Was the infirmity or disease brought on by his
 Own vice or intemperance?
- (d) Is the infirmity or disease the actual cause of
 or Contracted in the discharge of Police duty and
 without his own default?
- (e) Is the infirmity or disease especially attributable to
 the nature of Police duty?
- (f) Is his retirement necessitated or materially
 Accelerated by such infirmity or disease?
- (g) Is his capability contribute to his own support:-
 - (a) Slightly impaired
 - (b) Impaired
 - (c) Materially impaired
 - (d) Totally destroyed

Signature.....

Dated this.....Day of.....20.....